

PSYCHIC NUCLEAR POINTS CONTINUED -- PROCESS IN THE NOW

Greetings, all my dearest, dearest friends here. May you all receive the blessings, the strength, and the love that are poured forth as a result of your combined efforts and commitments to your innermost being. I shall continue in this lecture the sequence of the topic I started last time. Once again I ask you to open your innermost sensitivity and intuitiveness in order to understand, at least to some degree, the deep meaning of this lecture. Bringing your intellect alone to it will not give you an adequate comprehension of the depth of this topic. And again, like with the last lecture, what may first appear as purely abstract cosmic knowledge about creative processes will, when you pursue it and follow me all the way, lead into the second part of the lecture and become clearly and immediately applicable to your life here and now. Your own inner processes will become more comprehensible when you perceive, to whatever degree, how these processes are directly related to and part of larger cosmic processes that continuously exist.

I explained to you in the last lecture about psychic nuclear points and psychic nuclear spiral configurations. I will briefly recapitulate these in order to make this lecture more comprehensible.

Every smallest particle of creation consists of endless series of psychic nuclear spiral configurations that are intense energy movements winding up in a climactic point which brings the particular creation into manifestation on whatever level of reality that may be. Each of these configurations consists of a series of psychic events -- of consciousness content. In other words, these energy movements are not merely mechanical constructs that simply exist separately from mind. They are always expressions of mind -- greater mind or smaller minds, as the case may be. Each creation has sequences of several such configurations that intertwine, interweave, overlap, form, reform themselves, create and fall apart and recreate themselves in ever self-renewing, perpetuating, extending patterns of interacting spiral configurations. Each pattern may seem, and be, a creation within itself, quite different and purposeful within its more narrow framework. Yet, at the same time, it is part of a larger scheme of purposeful patterns of creation.

Let me give you a simple example on the physical level. Let us suppose you decide to get up from your chair, to move through this room, walk down the stairs and out to the street corner -- for whatever purpose. That total plan is one configuration, one spiral. As you arrive at your destination, the explosive, climactic point has brought the plan into manifestation. This particular creation has made its appearance on this level of reality. However, before this result can come into being, you have to take so-and-so many steps. Each step is a plan in itself, is an intent to move certain muscles because even though you may move these muscles automatically by now, this intent still exists. The intent, the movement, and the execution of the intent follow a certain plan. The plan, together with the execution in each particle, creates many smaller (the terms small or large are not correct on this level of reality, but I have to use them for lack of better words in your language) spiral configurations, complete in themselves. Each step is a creation of a spiral form and psychic

nuclear end point, complete with consciousness content, purpose, plan, and execution. The total walk consists of a "larger" such total form consisting of those "smaller" ones (the individual steps). But the walk from here to the corner is not an isolated creation either. It, too, is part of a larger scheme, a plan, a purpose, an intent of which the walk is just as much a partial creation, as the step is a partial creation of the walk from here to the corner. This formula is very important for you to understand because it represents the scheme of creation itself.

Let us take another example. Suppose you wish to build a house. Again the same principle applies. So-and-so many partial, creative, spiral forms converge into a whole which in turn is, again, only a part of a larger plan. So, when planning your house, you may first have to work for a number of years to be able to purchase the property and then to hire the architect who plans and designs the house. The architect, in turn, must execute his own plan: hire a contractor who organizes the work with various sub-contractors who must cooperate with one another; then laborers and interior decorators work until the house is finished. Each goes through an infinite number of a series of interacting psychic nuclear points, each totally formed in its own perfection, the whole of which becoming part of a larger plan and scheme, and so on and on. Each step in its smallest particle is a creation in itself. Each "little" creation is an explosion of a psychic spiral formation. The larger creation consists of so many smaller ones which extend and extend. For example, the purpose of the house itself is only an infinitesimal step of a whole larger series of creative, intertwining events. You may follow through yourself, with some imagination, how this house is relatively only a small step in a larger scheme. This larger scheme, too, is only an infinitesimal step in a still larger scheme -- as this one human life is when considered over a whole period of its evolutionary spiral movement.

This is a very important process for you to intuitively visualize. The examples I gave are very simple. Yet even in these simple examples, you can perhaps imagine how many psychic nuclear points are necessary to exist and weave a whole network of larger psychic nuclear points, which in turn move, create, explode, fall apart, form together in a new meaningful pattern related to the larger plan. Trying to imagine the, for you, unimaginable meaning and purposefulness behind these plannings may give you an inkling of the divine mind at work at all times in its benign, loving wisdom and power of creation. Understanding these principles even to a small degree will give you another insight, namely that even an insignificant act like walking from here to the street corner is indeed a creation. It requires the most brilliant creative genius to set in motion the energy systems, the muscular coordination and control, and the innumerable components necessary to execute such a creative act with all that forms part of it. And walking from here to the street corner is not an isolated creation. You must have a reason to walk there, and that reason, again, is only a small part of a larger plan or scheme. This interweaving, forever accelerating, enlarging, self-perpetuating process of creative patterns, each in itself a perfection within its own fragment and this fragment only a part of a larger fragment and so on and on, is a vague sketch of the creative process per se, always at work.

Imagine the creation of a planet; of the human anatomy; of a mathematical system; of the literally infinite qualities contained in the ether, and still you may not even vaguely perceive how many entire systems of creation, systems within smaller systems are contained in the creation of each of these examples. There could be no smallest particle of air that is not in itself a perfect creation of a psychic nuclear spiral point and climatic explosion. Each of these particles is a part of a larger scheme, as I illustrated with other examples. I only wish to convey that the smallest or biggest

creation -- from your point of view -- undergoes the same serial law that is the basis of creation itself. This is why I repeat myself. It will help you to perceive this process when you look at your inner makeup, your reactions, and the creations of your mind. For the same principle exists of course with positive and negative creations.

Since the universe is filled with being, there could be no smallest measure where there is nonbeing. Now, each of these nuclear points has a content and has a meaning. It is not separate from consciousness. It is an integral part and a result of consciousness. And when you understand the inner meaning of a nuclear point, when you perceive a nuclear spiral point, fully comprehending its meaning and purpose, its message, you will have transcended, to a certain degree, the narrow confinement in which you suffer from seeing the world out of context. Now, the less you see that these smaller part-creations are only fragmentary particles of a whole, the more you believe that the smaller particle is all there is and has no connection with anything else -- simply because you cannot perceive more, and thus the more fragmentized you must be yourself in your momentary consciousness or sense of awareness. When I say momentary, I mean by this as long as you reside within the narrow confines of human limitations.

Conversely, the more you perceive that everything that you can experience is only a smaller part and fragment of a larger and still larger ongoing plan -- like the one step you make as part of the whole walk and the walk being a fragment of a larger plan in your mind -- the more you are aware of and connected with the All-Consciousness, the Whole. Therefore, you are nearer to bliss.

Time itself is a manifestation of this fragmentation. For time, as I often said, is nothing but the illusion of a disconnected view of reality. In the framework of this particular topic, time is a perception only of the partial steps, the "smaller" creative units of spiral nuclear points, without seeing the whole structure of this particle. This is why man suffers so often of the feeling of senselessness. When he is in this limited state of consciousness, he is indeed fragmented and oblivious of the larger process.

Time, according to man's state of consciousness, is experienced as a sequence and not as a part of a whole -- the whole is experienced not linearly, but all the way, endlessly in width, depth, and scope, in dimensions that the human mind cannot even perceive at this point of its development. Each moment of time, to speak in your terms -- each moment of being, to speak in my terms -- is in itself a psychic nuclear construct containing meaning and consciousness, containing a purposeful design. Each fragmentary second is that. If you string along second upon second upon second -- not only sequentially, but in depth and width -- you may perceive that there is no time and that this is a point of creation that is endless and is always there. And that is what we might call the "now point."

It is not entirely impossible, in man's present state of development, to occasionally experience the now point -- the sense of it. But this requires much higher states of consciousness, and that must be earned. Mankind, as a whole, has now just about left kindergarten. When consciousness grows and matures a little and therefore perceives life not only as the immediately obvious fragment, but instead senses that the fragment is a part of a larger fragment and so on and on; then the consciousness prepares itself for experiencing the now point. A person may have only occasional inklings of such a perception, but these will be enough to imprint on the mind that there is much more to this life than what he immediately experiences in life.

Being in the now point means being completely in the now. This is what we are going to talk about in the second part of this lecture. Only when you are in the eternal now are you truly in bliss, are you truly safe, secure, fearless, and absolutely certain -- not as wishful thinking, but as absolute, realistic, justified inner certainty, as a fact -- of the beautiful meaning of life that is a continuum, that does not stop merely because certain momentary manifestations seem to stop. That sense of eternity is the true bliss. For when there is no fear, there is complete relaxation. The word "relaxation" could be misleading and I hesitate to use it, but the human language is limited, and we have to do as best as we can with the terms available. So let me perhaps describe a little what I mean here. A completely fearless state, without contraction and tension, is the state that makes this personality susceptible to the ever existing bliss of the universe. This, however, is far from being a passive state. Lack of tension does not imply flaccidity, motionlessness. It is an ever moving state in which the pulsatory changes of tension, in a different sense, alternate with openness and total receptivity. In the ordinary, human sense, the flexing is associated with tightening and defense. In the pure state, the tightening is a kind of charging so as to give spring to the creative movement that follows from it. This alternating movement of charge and let go is a creative whole which makes the entity participate in the creation. Both these movements are relaxed in the sense of being without fear and defense. They express a state of deep knowing that all is well in the universe.

This state is immensely blissful. Deep in the heart of all human beings, the longing for this bliss can never be extinguished. And when man fragmentizes his consciousness and creates the false reality of the three-dimensional world, inwardly he is still connected with the greater reality of eternal being and with the eternal now point. His manifest consciousness will constantly strive for this state, whether he knows it or not. This striving is in itself the motivating force to grow, to search, to move, to accept the temporary hardships which are self-created, and to walk through them as through tunnels so as to free the self from the obstruction. This requires, as you all know, a motivating force. For you constantly fluctuate in a battle between wanting to move and follow the longing or resisting to move and give up what your heart knows exists. This is a tremendously important struggle that each entity must go through. At one period in the evolutionary ascent, the struggle is won. The commitment is made to the movement even if it seems to bring momentary discomfort or hardship. Of course that is an illusion. What is discomfort and hardship exists and must manifest whether or not the entity decides to move in the direction of his own inner destiny. To follow this move is the only real way the hardship can be understood and therefore really dissolved. Denial of the hardship only appears temporarily to eliminate it so that the further illusion that the hardship appears to be created as a result of the decision to turn inward into the direction of the real self then comes into existence.

The striving for the bliss is the motor force, the motivational force that tips the scale of the inner battle between movement and stagnation, between reality and illusion, between fulfillment and despair, on the side of movement, reality, and fulfillment. This must occur at one stage or another. However, man also seeks shortcuts. He sometimes wants to attain the fulfillment of the longing without paying the price. The price is the labor of search, of seeking and finding, of learning, of growing, of changing, of self-purification, of traversing all self-created pain and evil.

Now let us briefly consider what such shortcuts may be. Several are possible. Let me list a few. Sexual activity can be such a shortcut. In sexual experience the blissful now is most often experienced, although very rarely sustained. When sexuality is an escape from problems, difficulties,

and unpleasant aspects of reality, then it is sought as a cheap way of attaining a semblance of universal bliss which the heart knows exists. Of course, as all cheating, it cannot work. The bliss will, at best, be a very illusory and short-lived one. When the blissful universal state of the eternal now is attained through honest growth, sexual union will be but one expression of it as the result of two beings relating on the deepest, most honest level, who fuse their spirituality, their emotional selves, their minds, and their physical beings. The bliss that results from this is then a foretaste of the now point. Or, the now point will be temporarily experienced.

The most blatant false search for the now point is through drugs. Indeed, the drug experience removes the physical, three-dimensional boundaries and thus reveals the reality behind the great curtain. But when this revelation occurs without earning it by making the state of consciousness compatible with this experience, then the price is high. I hardly need to illustrate the point. The same applies, of course, to alcohol. It is always a combination of two aspects of the personality. On the one hand, there is the great urge to be in a blissful state which a part of the personality "remembers" and desires, and, on the other hand, there is a resistance to the work that should be done. The attempt to compromise between these two sides is the cause of such false ways to attaining the now point. The fall from the bliss state is then all the more painful and the state of ordinary, physical consciousness all the more dark. In Scripture, the fall of the angels is often symbolized as a one-time happening. But it is a reality outside time that occurs whenever the fragmented state of consciousness accrues as a result of violating some spiritual law. The false search for the now point is a violation in that it wants to gain the result without paying the price. The insistence to be in heaven without being ready for it makes the personality plunge into hell.

Meditational exercises are another way in which man often seeks the bliss state. Offhand it would appear that this is an honest search, for it almost always entails a lengthy practice of concentration exercises and sometimes even a quite ascetic way of life which is supposed to prepare the personality for the experience. This, too, is ever so often an illusion. Extended fasting, concentration exercises, chanting, and self-hypnotic reiteration of meditational phrases can indeed produce results. There can be a temporary experience that reveals the great world behind the curtain. But if all these practices are substitutions for self-search, self-purification, and for change from the depths of the distortions, they will in essence be similar to the more crassly destructive escape routes such as we mentioned before. If the meditational exercises are mechanical, the way is an illusory one. Only when the now point is a result of slowly earned development, will the new perceptions be truly yours. Otherwise a lot of energy is being put forcefully into something that cannot be maintained with a feeling of ease and that must eventually split off from the undeveloped parts which are then pushed out of consciousness. Thus a tremendous contradiction occurs. The blissful now point is truly a result of unification. If this unification is not honestly attained and shortcuts are being sought, then, instead of unifying, an even greater split will occur. In fact, in such a case the personality started off less split than it will find itself after temporarily tasting and savoring the blissful now points by artificially induced means. I include mechanical exercises and practices as such means.

There is only one safe and secure way to attain the blissful now point, the revelation of reality in its unlimited dimensions, and that is by fulfilling the task for which you have come. Only a path such as this can help you do so. You must learn to go through your pain -- the pain of your illusion, of your guilts, of your undeveloped side. Ultimately this is what it all amounts to.

What is really the nature of the state when that now point is lost? It is not being aware of, it is being cut off from, spiritual reality. It is thinking that the temporary reality you have created, an illusory reality (if I may coin this apparently paradoxical phrase), is reality.

I now come to the most crucial part of this lecture. I said before that being in the now point is being aware, intensely aware, of the meaning of this now point. Whenever you strive away from the now point, you lose the meaning of it, you lose awareness of the meaning of it. You then create a superimposed false reality. This happens in several ways. In the first place, not being in the eternal now, in terms of time, is due to being either in the past or in the future -- not in the present, in the infinitesimal present. One can be in the present to some degree but still not truly aware of the now point. When you are in the future, you are in each minute already ahead -- perhaps in the next minute, the next hour, the next day, or even some far away "future" in a wishdream of how one day it will be or should be or could be by magic, but you bypass the now point that could give you the key to actually working toward that cherished future point. Or you hang on to something from the past that governs you, often without your even knowing it.

Your pathwork brings you in connection with both. Often you become aware only after laborious groping how your past has influenced you. For instance, it makes you react to something that takes place now as if it were still the past, and in this distorted vision you actually believe the event to be the same as a past one. Not that this belief is articulated. If it were, you would be nearer to the now point. The fact that you are convinced your present reaction is an appropriate one to the now is a measure of your alienation from the now point. The degree of such superimpositions from the past to the present is much, much stronger than even you, my friends, realize. And you have seen some of this. As you grow further, you will become more conscious of this "time projection." What you often believe are free actions determined by the current situations are not at all freely chosen actions but are determined by events and reactions you had that may or may not have been appropriate then. In either case, they are not appropriate now and lead to distortion of reality, thus to a false creation that blots out your connection with the real now.

By the same token, when you objectively view your life, you will see how much your wishes and your striving into the future determine your experience -- and therefore your lack of true depth experience -- now. So you lose the now point as a result of the past and the future that tear at you, as it were, from both directions. Crassly speaking, this lack of awareness of what really takes place creates the time illusion. Or, to put it differently, the false reality, the lack of self-awareness creates a fragmentation and a disconnectedness.

However, to be in the now point, to comprehend its meaning, not to live in the past or in the future is not something you can directly determine in your mind by an act of will. The act of will comes into play, but it must go toward establishing self-awareness in all those mundane aspects that are unwelcome for you to face and deal with. Only then will you be in truth, only in that way can you establish a sense of reality. And only as a consequence of that, will a new sense of timelessness evolve spontaneously, effortlessly, when you least expect it. It will come as a by-product of your search for your truth. Only indirectly as a result of self-exploration, will the past cease to be the present. You will then completely trust the future because you will know that it can only be an extension of the now. If you are in full truth in the now, you build a "future" (in your terms) that can be wholly trusted. Thus you don't need to toy in a wishful way with the future because you don't need to escape from the present. Then the forever now takes on a new reality.

Other ways in which you lose the now point of each fragmentary moment in time in which you exist, in which you breathe, in which you think and will and feel and experience are very familiar to you who have spent time and effort on this path. They are even quite known in this material world by psychological schools who attempt to find the inner self. They seem to have little to do with cosmic and creative processes. In your world today, they seem quite humdrum concepts far removed from such topics as we discuss now. But they are indeed very intensely connected with the processes under discussion. These are (1) displacement, (2) projection, (3) denial.

I will give simple examples of each. Then you can use these examples for your further pathwork, for your further self-exploration. Suppose there is something painful in you that you struggle against (and you all know how much you struggle in that respect). You lose the now point, for example, through displacement. Let us take the example when you love a person dearly who hurts and angers you. You do not wish to offend that person. If you show your feelings, the consequences may incur the loss of that person whom you need and are dependent on. This would cause a pain you wish to avoid. Nevertheless that person has done something to you that pains and angers you. Acknowledging that pain may also destroy a bubble of illusion you do not wish to give up. Perhaps the illusion is that the beloved person ought to be perfect and never do things to hurt you. The purpose of your illusion itself is to avoid unpleasantness (in this case, confrontation) and/or risk (the possible loss of the loved one). You hope to avoid all risks, discomforts, and pains by building an illusion into which you invest quite a bit of energy so that you can maintain its fictional reality. Nevertheless, the energy of the pain and anger you experience is very real, and it needs to be disposed of. It is another aspect of the illusion that by not acknowledging pain and anger they will simply "go away." The mechanism by which you try to "solve" this problem (often so automatic that it is not even perceived) is that the feelings for this beloved and important person are put onto another person, perhaps on another issue. This other person may not mean as much to you; his anger, rejection, and retaliation may be less "dangerous" to you. Or you are so secure in this person's love, tolerance, and understanding that you can safely put this load on him. In that way, you have "solved" the problem by finding a necessary outlet for a tight energy accumulation without jeopardizing the relationship with the all-important figure in your life. This is what I call displacement. Quite apart from the guilt about the dishonesty of such a shrewd device, it also creates a false reality. This is easy to see. You begin to live in a self-created world that has no bearing on what reality is. This makes you completely unaware of every fractional now point. You cannot discern its meaning or message until you are willing to set it all straight again.

Many of you have sufficiently advanced on your path and have experienced any number of times that when you fully face the most undesirable, dishonest, and petty infringements of truth in you, you get into a state of bliss, even before you necessarily change that part of you simply by honestly dealing with the issue. The reason for this is that you are in this particular now point of your untruthfulness, of your deceitfulness, of your negativity. Displacement creates chaos and disorder. It creates a total confusion about what really is. It creates a total disconnectedness from the continuum of your inner existence. Thus it must create fear and fragmentation. The example I used is a very frequent one and exists in your lives to a much larger degree than you presently realize. Here and there you see some of your displacement, but not nearly to the degree they still go on in all of you. You so often shift something from one person to another, from one situation to another. Sometimes you are just too lazy and too resistant by habit to deal with the real situation. Then it "comes out" in the false one. There can be no question about coming into your forever changing

and self-renewing and ongoing now point unless you stop that procedure, unless you fully make up your mind to see what you are doing and to what extent you are doing it. The lack of awareness of how you are doing it makes the problem only much greater. The minute you see you have the problem of automatic displacement, the problem is already diminished.

Let us now take projection. You are a little more familiar with that, but even here you are still often quite blind to how you react to others precisely because you do not wish to see something in yourself. Sometimes the other person may indeed have the undesirable trait, though at other times this may not even be the case. But whether or not it is, it matters little. The important thing is that the energy that should be used toward facing, confronting, dealing with the aspect is being abused by becoming angry and annoyed at the other person. You do this because you wish to maintain an illusion about yourself -- namely that you do not have the trait in question.

Denial is of course quite self-explanatory. You neither displace nor project what you do not wish to experience, but you attempt to simply deny its existence. All these procedures -- being influenced by the past; striving toward the future; displacement, projection, and denial -- are attempts to get away from the now point in the illusion that something can be avoided that is in any way unpleasant. You create by force a new reality that is not founded on truth. In essence this means abusing the creative faculties. What really is accomplished is the creation of more fragmentization, a further alienation from the psychic nuclear now point with all its glorious meaning and relationship to the whole.

The love of all your friends who work in this beautiful venture is streaming forth to all of you. The blessings will multiply in your heart and in your deeper minds as you let yourself feel these blessings. Be your innermost God.

For information to find and participate in Pathwork activities world wide, please write:

The Pathwork® Foundation
PO Box 6010
Charlottesville, VA 22906-6010, USA
Call: 1-800-PATHWORK, or
Visit: www.pathwork.org

The following notices are for your guidance in the use of the Pathwork® name and this lecture material.

Trademark/Service Mark

Pathwork® is a registered service mark owned by The Pathwork Foundation, and may not be used without the express written permission of the Foundation. The Foundation may, in its sole discretion, authorize use of the Pathwork® mark by other organizations or persons, such as affiliate organizations and chapters.

Copyright

The copyright of the Pathwork Guide material is the sole property of The Pathwork Foundation. This lecture may be reproduced, in compliance with the Foundation Trademark, Service Mark and Copyright Policy, but the text may not be altered or abbreviated in any way, nor may the copyright, trademark, service mark, or any other notices be removed. Recipients may be charged the cost of reproduction and distribution only.

Any person or organization using The Pathwork Foundation service mark or copyrighted material is deemed to have agreed to comply with the Foundation Trademark, Service Mark and Copyright Policy. To obtain information or a copy of this policy, please contact the Foundation.